11.5 Cellulitis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My leg is red, hot and swollen." **Objective** • Spreading redness; warm skin • Temperature 38.4 °C • Raised white cell count	**ACTUAL** Impaired skin integrity related to bacterial infection of the skin as evidenced by erythema, swelling and warmth.	• Less redness and swelling within 72 hours.	• Mark the edge of the redness and check for spread. • Give antibiotics as prescribed. • Elevate the leg. • Follow temperature.	• Considered met as the redness recedes.
Subjective • Rates pain 6/10 **Objective** • Tender, swollen leg • Limping	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to tissue inflammation as evidenced by pain score.	• Pain at or below 3/10 within 24 hours.	• Give analgesia as prescribed. • Elevate the leg. • Keep tight coverings off the area.	• Goal reached when pain is controlled.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Infection spreading • Diabetes mellitus	**RISK** Risk for shock as evidenced by risk factors: possible sepsis.	• Vital signs stay stable.	• Take vital signs every 4 hours. • Report hypotension, confusion or fast-spreading redness.	• Met while he remains stable.

* **References for this care plan:** [20], [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.